Specification of the controlled designation of origin "COTEAUX CHAMPENOIS"

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CHAPTER I

I. – Name of the designation

Only wines meeting the provisions of the present specification, as well as the provisions of the law of 6 May 1919 on the protection of designations of origin and of law no. 77-523 of 23 May 1977, may claim the controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois", initially recognised by the decree of 21 August 1974.

II. – Geographical denominations and complementary terms

The name of the controlled designation of origin may be supplemented by the name of the commune from which the grapes come.

III. – Colour and types of product

The controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois" is reserved for still white, rosé and red wines.

IV. – Areas and zones in which the various operations are carried out

The harvesting of the grapes, the vinification, the elaboration, the ageing and the packaging of the wines are carried out within the territories delimited by article 17 of the law of 6 May 1919, subject to the following provisions:

– in the arrondissement of Vitry-le-François (Marne department), the delimited parcel area is that approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 7 and 8 November 1990, the plans of which are lodged at the town halls of the communes concerned;

– in the following communes of the Aube department: Arsonval, Cunfin, Dolancourt, Jaucourt, the delimited parcel area is that approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its sessions of 23 June 1994, 8 September 1994 and 19 May 1995, the plans of which are lodged at the town halls of the communes concerned;

– in the following communes of the Aube department: Brienne-le-Château, Epagne, Précy-Saint-Martin and Saint-Léger-sous-Brienne, and in the following communes of the Marne department: Esclavolle-Lurey, Potangis, Saint-Quentin-le-Verger and Villiers-aux-Corneilles, no parcel was selected, in accordance with the decisions of the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its sessions of 23 and 24 June 1994, 7 and 8 September 1994, 18 and 19 May 1995 and 6 and 7 September 1995;

– in the following communes of the Aube department: Marcilly-le-Hayer and La Villeneuve-au-Châtelot, no parcel was selected, in accordance with the decision of the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 10 September 1997;

– in the Marne commune of Fontaine-sur-Ay, the delimited parcel area is that approved by the competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 9 and 10 September 1999, the plans of which are lodged at the town hall of the commune concerned;

– in the following communes of the Marne department: Corfélix, Corrobert, Le Thoult-Trosnay, Verdon, Reuves and Broussy-le-Petit, no parcel was selected, in accordance with the decision of the

competent national committee of the National Institute of Origin and Quality at its session of 5 and 6 September 2001.

V. – Grape varieties

1° – Grape varieties

The wines come exclusively from the following varieties:

- main varieties: Arbane B, Chardonnay B, Chardonnay rose Rs, Meunier N, Petit meslier B, Pinot blanc B, Pinot gris G, Pinot noir N;

- and the variety “of interest for adaptation purposes”: Voltis B, subject to the signature between the INAO, the ODG, the authorised operator concerned, the operator-vinifier and the producer (élaborateur) of an agreement conforming to the framework agreement approved by the competent national committee of 2 June 2021.

2° – Proportion rule on the holding

a) The proportion of the main varieties is greater than or equal to 95 % of the planting.

b) The proportion of the variety “of interest for adaptation purposes” is less than or equal to 5 % of the planting.

In order to encourage the reduction of plant-protection inputs in areas adjoining inhabited/urbanised zones, the areas planted with Voltis and situated less than 20 metres from the places mentioned in Article L253-7-1, in I of Article L253-7 and in III of Article L253-8 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code are not taken into account in calculating the areas of varieties “of interest for adaptation purposes” subject to the limit of 5 % of the area of the holding declared under the AOC.

VI. – Management of the vineyard

1° – Training methods

a) Planting density

General provisions:

The vines are planted with a spacing between rows that may not exceed 2.00 metres. The spacing between plants within the same row is between 0.70 metre and 1.50 metres.

The sum of the spacing between rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not exceed 3.00 metres.

Any transformation of the parcel resulting in a change in planting density is prohibited until it is grubbed up.

Particular provisions:

In order to allow the passage of suitable machinery, parcels with:

- either a slope greater than 35 %,

- or a slope greater than 25 % combined with a cross-slope greater than 10 %,

may have alleys between 1.50 metres and 3 metres wide, at a maximum frequency of one row in six. In this case, the sum of the spacing between the other rows and the spacing between plants within the same row may not exceed 2.30 metres.

b) Pruning rules

A “free eye” means a bud separated from the base of the cane or “crown”, whatever the length of the internode.

Any overlapping between plants and any superposition of fruiting branches is prohibited.

The number of free eyes is less than or equal to 18 eyes per square metre.

Pruning is carried out at the latest before phenological stage (F) (Lorenz 12), i.e. four leaves unfolded.

The vines are pruned according to the following techniques:

SO-CALLED “CHABLIS PRUNING”	
Description	a) Chablis pruning comprises at most one framework per 0.30 metre. b) Each framework bears a fruiting extension at its end, pruned with a maximum of 5 free eyes. c) A replacement spur known as the “rachet”, pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes, is left at the base of the stock.
Particular requirements	The stocks must be set up so that the bud at the end of the extensions is at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular provision	a) If a framework is missing, a “rentrure” of a maximum of 2 free eyes may be made on one of the frameworks, in addition to the replacement or rejuvenation spur (known as the rachet) at the base of the stock; b) Vines planted with the meunier N variety and with a spacing within the row greater than 1.20 metres may be trained with 3 frameworks each bearing a fruiting extension, laid on a wire and pruned with a maximum of 6 free eyes.
CORDON (ROYAT) PRUNING	
Description	A single horizontal framework is established, without limitation of length, at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular requirements	The spurs are spaced at least 0.15 metre apart and are pruned to a maximum of 3 free eyes. The replacement spur known as the “rachet”, at the base of the cordon, is pruned to 2 free eyes. The extension is pruned to a maximum of 5 free eyes. Rejuvenation of the cordon may be carried out in one or more stages.
Particular provisions	a) In the case of progressive rejuvenation by means of young wood, but without removal of the old framework, this young wood is trained along the old framework. Spurs requiring it are removed from the old framework so that there is no superposition or juxtaposition between the shoots of the two frameworks, and provided that the rejuvenation is not renewed each year on the same plant. b) The establishment of a framework in the opposite direction to that originally existing (known as a “retour”), intended to fill an accidental gap, is possible provided that it does not give rise to a launch of young wood renewed each year. c) The annual percentage of rejuvenation must not exceed 20 % of the plants of a single parcel.
MARNE VALLEY PRUNING	
Description	a) The vines are pruned with: – one spur of a maximum of 3 free eyes per plant; – a cane launched from the previous year’s spur and bearing a maximum of 9 free eyes; – an extension (fruiting) established at the end of the previous year’s cane and bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes. b) The fruiting extension is tied horizontally at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular requirements	This pruning technique is only authorised for the meunier N variety.

SO-CALLED “CHABLIS PRUNING”	
Particular provisions	a) Where a new cane is not launched every year, one of the two frameworks may bear a rejuvenation spur, known as a “rentrure”, pruned to a maximum of 2 free eyes. The spur at the base of the plant is then pruned to a maximum of 3 free eyes. b) On total rejuvenation of one of the two frameworks, the launch taken from the spur is pruned to a maximum of 8 free eyes. The fruiting extensions are tied horizontally at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
SINGLE GUYOT AND DOUBLE GUYOT PRUNING	
Description	a) The vines are pruned: – by single Guyot pruning with one spur of a maximum of 3 free eyes and one cane of a maximum of 10 free eyes; – by double Guyot pruning with at most 2 spurs of a maximum of 2 free eyes and at most 2 canes of a maximum of 8 free eyes, of which a maximum of 6 are placed horizontally on the wire. b) The canes are tied at a maximum height of 0.60 metre above ground level.
Particular provisions	In single Guyot, the canes may have 12 free eyes if they are arched. This cane must be tied on 2 wires 0.20 metre apart and the terminal bud must be tied at a height of 0.60 metre. In double Guyot, the canes may have a maximum of 10 free eyes if they are arched. This cane must be tied on 2 wires 0.20 metre apart and the terminal bud must be tied at a height of 0.60 metre.
ASYMMETRICAL GUYOT PRUNING	
Description	a) The vines are pruned: – with a rachet of a maximum of 2 free eyes; – a launch bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes; – an extension (fruiting) established at the end of the previous year’s launch, or of a framework more than 2 years old, and bearing a maximum of 6 free eyes. b) The arrangement of the wood must be such that the last buds are at a maximum height of 0.60 metre.

c) Trellising rule

The trellising system is in place at the latest in the year of entry into production under the controlled designation of origin.

d) Tying

Tying is completed before phenological stage (I) (Lorenz 23), known as “flowering”, and is consistent with the pruning system adopted.

e) Lifting

Lifting the shoots held by wires is compulsory. It is carried out at the latest at phenological stage (L) (Lorenz stage 33), known as “bunch closure”.

f) Foliage height

The height of trellised foliage, after trimming, is at least equal to 0.6 times the spacing between rows. It is measured between the tying wire and the upper trimming limit.

g) Average maximum load per parcel

The average maximum load per parcel is set at 19,700 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

The number of bunches per square metre of vine in production is less than or equal to 17.

h) Threshold of missing vines

The percentage of dead or missing vine plants referred to in Article D. 645-4 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 20 %.

i) Cultivation condition of the vine

The parcels are managed so as to ensure a good overall cultivation condition of the vine, in particular its sanitary condition and the upkeep of its soil.

2° – Other cultivation practices

In order to preserve the characteristics of the soils, which constitute a fundamental element of the terroir:

a) Permanent grass cover of the headlands is compulsory;

b) The use of composts and organic household waste, and of sewage sludge other than that from wine-making installations, alone or mixed, is prohibited;

c) The maximum width of the strip that may be chemically weeded is 40 centimetres on either side of the vine row;

d) The inter-row must have a plant cover, spontaneous or sown, from 30 November to 31 January of the following year;

e) Vine plantings and replacements are carried out with plants all of whose components (scions and rootstocks) have been hot-water treated before grafting. Failing this, the plants are hot-water treated before planting. Hot-water treatment must be carried out in a station approved by FranceAgriMer;

f) Any substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin is prohibited, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works.

3° – Irrigation

Irrigation is prohibited.

VII. – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes

1° – Harvest

a) The wines come from grapes harvested at good ripeness.

The date of the start of the harvest is set in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-6 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

A date for the end of picking is set by prefectoral order on the proposal of the services of the National Institute of Origin and Quality, after consulting the defence and management body.

b) Particular harvesting provisions

Any means that does not allow whole bunches of grapes to be harvested is prohibited.

c) Particular provisions for transport of the harvest

The grapes are transported whole to the pressing or vinification installations.

The baskets, boxes and crates used to transport the grapes from the place of picking to the pressing or vinification installation must have holes in the bottom and on all sides allowing rapid and complete drainage of the juice while awaiting pressing or vinification.

2° – Ripeness of the grapes

a) Sugar content of the grapes

Grapes with a sugar content of less than 143 grams per litre of must may not be considered to be at good ripeness.

b) Minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume

The wines have a minimum natural alcoholic strength by volume of 9 %.

VIII. – Yields – Entry into production

1° – Yield

The yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 12,400 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

2° – Limit yield

The limit yield referred to in Article D. 645-7 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code is set at 15,500 kilograms of grapes per hectare.

3° – Entry into production of the vines

The benefit of the controlled designation of origin may only be granted to wines coming from parcels of young vines from the second year following that in the course of which planting was carried out in place before 31 July.

4° – Particular provisions

a) White wines

- the wines are obtained within the limit of a volume of 102 litres of settled must per 160 kilograms of grapes used. For a given harvest, taking particular account of its characteristics, an inter-ministerial order may reduce this volume;

- the lees resulting from pressing are extracted in a proportion of between 1 % and 4 % of the quantity of settled musts. They are eliminated in compliance with the provisions governing the elimination of by-products before 31 January of the year following the harvest;

- musts intended for the elaboration of wines liable to benefit from the controlled designation of origin are settled before any exit from the pressing centre;

- press wines obtained at the end of pressing beyond the maximum authorised yield are treated as rebêches.

b) Red wines and rosé wines made by maceration or saignée

- the wines are obtained within the limit of a volume of 102 litres of wine per 160 kilograms of grapes used, after draining and pressing. For a given harvest, taking particular account of its characteristics, an inter-ministerial order may reduce this volume;

- press wines obtained at the end of pressing beyond the maximum authorised yield are treated as rebêches.

c) Taking into account for the controlled designation of origin

The wines are taken into account for the controlled designation of origin, at the latest when the harvest declaration is made, at the rate of 98.5 % of their volume.

d) Rate of rebêches

- the rate of rebêches is a minimum extraction of between 0 % and 10 % of the quantity of settled musts eligible for the controlled designation of origin;

- these rebêches are eliminated before 15 December of the year following that of the harvest.

IX. – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage

1° – General provisions

The wines are vinified in accordance with local, fair and constant usages.

a) Reception and pressing

- For the elaboration of white wines, pressing must be carried out in presses able to receive, as whole grapes, at least 2,000 kilograms and at most 12,000 kilograms of grapes per load. The presses used must allow the musts to be fractionated into cuvée and taille;

- For the elaboration of red and rosé wines, the use of presses with a capacity of less than 2,000 kilograms is authorised.

b) Malolactic fermentation

Malolactic fermentation is completed for red wines. At the packaging stage, red wines have a malic acid content less than or equal to 0.4 gram per litre.

c) Analytical standards

The wines have a fermentable sugar content (glucose and fructose) less than or equal to 3 grams per litre.

d) Oenological practices and treatments

The use of pieces of wood is prohibited.

For the elaboration of rosé wines, the use of oenological charcoal, alone or mixed in preparations, is prohibited.

After enrichment, the wines do not exceed a total alcoholic strength by volume of 13 %.

The increase in the volume of fermenting must used may not exceed 1.12 % for each 1 % increase in the alcoholic strength by volume during the enrichment operation.

Excess volumes are eliminated in compliance with the provisions governing the elimination of by-products before 15 December of the year following that of the harvest, in accordance with the provisions of Article D. 645-14 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code.

e) Upkeep of the cellar and equipment

The cellar (floor and walls) and the vinification equipment are in a good general state of upkeep.

2° – Provisions by type of product

a) The wines are aged at least until 15 August of the year following that of the harvest.

b) The elaboration of the wines entails the elimination, before 31 July of the year following that of the harvest, of the by-products of vinification at the rate of 1.5 % of the settled musts.

c) The wines come from one or more varieties. They may not come solely from the variety “of interest for adaptation purposes”.

The proportion of the main variety or varieties is greater than or equal to 90 % of the blend. The proportion of the variety “of interest for adaptation purposes” is less than or equal to 10 % of the blend.

3° – Provisions relating to packaging

a) The wines are packaged in new bottles.

b) For every packaged lot, the operator keeps available for the approved control body:

- the information appearing in the register of handling operations referred to in Article D. 645-18 of the Rural and Maritime Fishing Code;

- an analysis carried out before or after packaging.

The analysis reports are kept for a period of sixty months from the date of packaging.

4° – Provisions relating to storage

The operator provides evidence of a specific place for the storage of packaged products.

5° – Provisions relating to the circulation of products and placing on the market for the consumer

a) Date of placing on the market for the consumer

At the end of the ageing period, the wines are placed on the market for the consumer from 15 October of the year following that of the harvest.

b) Circulation with an accompanying document

Grapes and all products intended for the elaboration of a wine of the controlled designation of origin may only circulate with an accompanying document bearing the name of the controlled designation of origin from a commune belonging to the geographical area defined in IV of the present specification to another commune belonging to that same area, in application of article 466 of the General Tax Code.

X. – Link with the geographical area

1° – Information on the geographical area

a) Description of the natural factors contributing to the link

The geographical area corresponds to that of the controlled designation of origin “Champagne”. It is situated in the north-east of French territory and extends over communes spread across the departments of the Aisne, Aube, Haute-Marne, Marne and Seine-et-Marne.

As for the geographical area, the parcels selected for the harvesting of the grapes correspond to those delimited for the controlled designation of origin Champagne.

They form part of a landscape characterised by a hillside vineyard lying on the cuestas of the eastern Paris Basin, imposing geomorphological structures:

– the Côte d’Île-de-France in the Marne, together with the slopes of the associated valleys, grouping from north to south the Montagne de Reims, the Marne valley (which extends into the south of the Aisne and as far as Seine-et-Marne), the Côte des Blancs and the Côte du Sézannais for the most emblematic sectors;

– the Côte de Champagne, with the Marne Vitryat and the Aube sector of Montgueux;

– the Côte des Bar, cut by many valleys, bringing together the Bar-sur-Aubois to the east and the Barséquanais to the west, in the Aube and Haute-Marne.

This typical cuesta relief, with its adjacent valleys, presents hillsides facing east and south, sometimes north, as for the northern Montagne de Reims and the left bank of the Marne valley. The scarp crests are made up of hard layers of limestone or chalk. The slopes of the hillsides are chalky, marly or sandy, softer, cleared by erosion and then covered with colluvial deposits coming from the overlying scarp crests.

The vineyard is situated in a northern zone. It is subject to a double climatic influence:

- oceanic, bringing water in regular quantities with slight temperature contrasts from one season to the next;

- continental, responsible for sometimes destructive frosts and favourable sunshine in summer.

b) Description of the human factors contributing to the link

Going back to Antiquity, the vine was well established in Champagne by the 9th century, following the development of monastic viticulture. In the Middle Ages the wines were known as "Vins de France" because they were produced in the Paris Basin, on the edge of the royal domain.

Until the 18th century, the province of Champagne was above all a producer of red wines. According to Pierre Galet, their production far outweighed that of white and rosé wines (known as "paillets") before the prise de mousse by second fermentation in bottle was mastered.

In the 19th century, as the renown of the sparkling wines of Champagne grew, the production of red wines declined. Only a few great wines produced in the Montagne de Reims, the Grande Vallée de la Marne and the Aube retained a good reputation.

The law of 22 July 1927, reserving the appellation "Champagne" for sparkling wines alone, introduced the indication "Wines originating from viticultural Champagne", subsequently called, from 1953, "Vins natures de Champagne".

Rehabilitated thanks to the efforts of a few wine-growers who perpetuated the tradition of these "vins natures", the wines were recognised as the controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois" in 1974, following the provisions of the law of 12 December 1973, which prohibited the use of the simple appellation "vins natures de la Champagne".

Wines of the controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois" are only produced if the characteristics of the harvest are suited to the production of still wines. Their production therefore fluctuates greatly.

Anxious to prevent any fraudulent practice involving wines circulating in bulk, the producers requested the promulgation of the law of 23 May 1977, which prohibits any dispatch, other than in bottles, of wines produced under the controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois", with the exception of movements within delimited viticultural Champagne between Champagne operators.

Production is managed by the same professional organisations as those set up for the controlled designation of origin "Champagne", namely the Syndicat général des vignerons de Champagne (created in 1904) and the Union des Maisons de Champagne (founded in 1882), brought together in the Comité Interprofessionnel des Vins de Champagne (created in 1941).

2° – Information on the quality and characteristics of the product

These are still red, white and rosé wines, often designated by the name of the commune where the grapes were harvested.

The red wines have a transparent red robe of variable intensity and the rosé wines have a light robe ranging from pale pink to dark salmon. These wines are all lightness and finesse, with a silky attack on the palate and aromas generally of red fruit.

The texture of the white wines is crystalline and saline, with a dominant minerality that generates fine persistence. Its natural acidity gives it a certain liveliness. They show subtle aromatic notes of a floral, fruity or mineral kind. Ageing brings richness to the wine and contributes to its balance on the palate.

3° – Causal interactions

The wide opening of the landscape of the three cuestas onto the plain and the valleys guarantees the vineyards sufficient light for the ripening of the berries, even for north-facing exposures. The east- and

south-facing exposure of the most renowned traditional sectors for the production of Coteaux champenois exposes the vineyards to maximum light in spring and autumn, thus offering optimal conditions for the flowering of the vine and the ripening of the berries. The open landscape prevents the stagnation of cold air and so reduces the risk of frost.

However, the climate of the Champagne region requires wine-growers to select only healthy grapes from the most clement years, chosen from the best parcels, most often old vines, and to harvest at full ripeness of the grapes.

The slope of the wine-growing hillsides ensures optimal natural drainage, also guaranteed by the different substrata, which allow natural water regulation of the vine. Chalk, through its porosity and permeability, eliminates excess water while ensuring rehydration of the soil in dry weather by capillary rise. The other subsoils combine marly levels, which provide the water reserve, with either limestone beds or carbonated sands, the latter allowing the infiltration of excess water during wet periods.

This nature of the subsoil and these delicate climatic conditions have guided the establishment of the varieties in the different regions of the vineyard.

The unique climatic situation of Champagne gives the grapes and then the wines a natural acidity, determining the lively character of the wine perceived on tasting and underlining the mineral notes brought by the substratum.

The wines often come from black grapes which, according to Jules Guyot, better withstand the effects of frost and rain and ripen more promptly. In 1822 André Jullien ranked “[the reds] of Verzy, Verzenay, Mailly, Saint-Basle, Bouzy and the clos de Saint-Thierry among the best wines of France, when they come from years in which the temperature was very hot and dry”.

The vinification of red or rosé wines, by more or less short maceration, best respects the aromas of the pinot noir N and meunier N varieties and their development during vatting. For white wines, preservation of the integrity of the grapes from harvest onwards and gentle pressing, according to Champagne usages, avoid colouring of the juices from black grapes and thus guarantee the clarity of the wine.

The red wines of the province of Champagne appeared among the great wines at the coronations of the kings at Reims as early as 1328 (Philippe de Valois), where the natural finesse of their bouquet made them especially appreciated. Powerful European sovereigns even acquired vines in the Montagne de Reims, and Henry IV insisted on taking the title of lord of Ay. The fine tasters of the court of Louis XIV, calling themselves “the order of the Coteaux”, consecrated the renown and reputation of these wines: “Spare no expense to have Champagne wine”, wrote Saint-Évremond to the Count of Olonne in 1671. “There is no province that supplies more excellent wines for all seasons than Champagne.” Many documents from the 17th to the 19th century record these praises; these wines occupy the “distinguished rank among the best fine wines of the kingdom” assigned to them by André Jullien in 1822.

Through the professionalism of its producers, this renown endures today. These wines should be tasted with respect and historical curiosity, bearing in mind that they are a survival from ancient times.

XI. – Transitional measures

1° – Training method

Vine parcels in place on 17 January 1978 that do not comply with the provisions relating to planting density continue to benefit, for their harvest, from the right to the controlled designation of origin until they are grubbed up, provided that the trellising and foliage height rules set out in the present specification are complied with.

XII. – Rules of presentation and labelling

a) Wines for which, under the terms of the present specification, the controlled designation of origin "Coteaux champenois" is claimed and which are presented under the said appellation may not be offered to the public, dispatched, put up for sale or sold unless, in advertisements, on leaflets, labels, invoices, any containers whatsoever, cases or packaging, the aforesaid controlled designation of origin is entered.

b) The labelling of wines benefiting from the controlled designation of origin may specify the name of a smaller geographical unit, provided that:

- it is the name of a registered cadastral lieu-dit;

- it appears on the harvest declaration.

The indication of a lieu-dit is only authorised if all the grapes used for the elaboration of the wines come from the lieu-dit concerned.

c) The grape variety may be indicated in characters whose dimensions, both in height and in width, are not greater than 3 millimetres and half the size of the characters composing the name of the controlled designation of origin. A variety may only be claimed if all the grapes come from that variety.

CHAPTER II

I. – Declaration obligations

1° – Declaration of adaptation of planting density under the particular provisions

Every operator adapting the planting density of a parcel under the particular planting provisions must lodge a declaration with the defence and management body at the latest within 48 hours following the end of the works. For each parcel concerned, the declaration specifies in particular:

- the cadastral references and the commune;

- the area.

2° – Declaration of parcel development

Before any development or any works liable to modify the morphology, the subsoil or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel intended for the production of the controlled designation of origin, with the exception of classic deep-ploughing works, the operator sends a declaration to the ODG at least 6 weeks before the planned start date of the works. The ODG transmits a copy of this declaration to the INAO services without delay.

3° – Claim declaration

The claim declaration must be sent to the approved control body before 31 July of the year following that of the harvest. It indicates in particular:

- the designation claimed;

- the volume of wine;

- the EVV number or, for authorised warehousekeepers who are merchants, the excise number;

- the name and address of the applicant;

- the place of storage of the wine.

4° – Declaration of intention to bottle

The declaration of intention to bottle is sent to the approved control body at least forty-eight hours before the start of the operation. It indicates in particular:

– the designation claimed and any particular claims;

– the estimated volume of wine to be used;

– the date of bottling;

– the place of bottling;

– the EVV number;

– the CIVC number;

– the name and address of the applicant.

II. – Keeping of registers

1° – Weighing register

Pressing centres must keep a weighing register separate from the press register. This register indicates for each weighing:

- the date and time of the weighing;

- the weight recorded;

- any particular claims (terms, indication of a lieu-dit name…).

For centres pressing on behalf of third parties, the weighing register also specifies the name of the operator delivering the grapes. A weighing ticket containing all these indications is issued to that operator.

2° – Press register

Keeping a press register is compulsory. It is filled in as the pressing operations proceed. This register specifies, for each press load (marc):

- the date and time of the start of each operation;

- the weight of grapes used, by variety;

- the origin of the grapes, in the case of particular claims (terms, indication of a lieu-dit name…);

- the name of the operator who delivered the grapes;

- the volumes of musts obtained;

- the potential alcoholic strength by volume;

- the volumes of rebêches.

For red and rosé wines, the quantity of wine obtained is only specified at the end of pressing.

CHAPTER III

I. – Main points to be checked and evaluation methods

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A – STRUCTURAL RULES	

MAIN POINTS TO BE CHECKED	EVALUATION METHODS
A1 – Belonging of the planted parcels to the delimited area	Documentary and visual on site
A2 – Claimable production potential (grape varieties, planting density and trellising system, entry of the vines into production)	Documentary and visual on site
A3 – Development of a parcel	Documentary and visual on site
A4 – Processing facilities	
Reception and pressing, pressing site	
B – RULES LINKED TO THE PRODUCTION CYCLE	
B1 – Management of the vineyard	
Pruning	Visual on site
Average maximum load per parcel	Visual on site
Cultivation condition of the vine	Visual on site
Use of composts and organic household waste, of sewage sludge other than that from wine-making installations. Substantial modification of the morphology, the subsoil or the elements that guarantee the integrity and sustainability of the soils of a parcel	Visual on site
B2 – Harvest, transport and ripeness of the grapes	
Monitoring of the harvest date	Documentary and visual on site
B3 – Processing, elaboration, ageing, packaging, storage	
Pressing	Documentary and visual on site (verification of compliance with the pressing rules)
B4 – Harvest declaration and claim declaration	
Authorised yield	Documentary, off site
Claim declaration	Documentary and visual on site – check of the release of products into circulation
C – CHECKS ON THE PRODUCTS	
Wines before or after packaging	Analytical and organoleptic examination

II. – References concerning the control structure

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Compliance with the present specification is checked on the basis of an approved control plan, by a third-party body offering guarantees of competence, impartiality and independence that has received delegation from the INAO.